The Northwind dig file

MOS-230 Culture Dig practical · Teaching case: Northwind Health is fictional.

The Northwind dig file

The next seven pages are the evidence for both parts. All names and figures are invented for teaching.

- **Part A** uses Exhibit 15: Taylor Brooks's request.
- **Part B** uses Exhibit 16, the evidence pack, with Exhibits 8, 9, 10 and 13.

Exhibit numbers match the full case. The exhibits not shown here were used in the modules.

Exhibit 8: Story patterns, wave 1 (saved Wed May 19, 2027)

Composite = 0.35 × Dyad positive % + 0.35 × Stones Healthy % + 0.30 × Triad non-concerning %. "Rests on" = stories behind the thinnest of the three inputs.

Domain	Stories	Rests on	Dyad + %	Stones Healthy %	Triad non-concerning %	Composite	95% margin	Range
Espoused Beliefs and Values	69	66	58	42	67	**55.1**	±5.0	50.1–60.1
HR Management Systems and Processes	61	58	42	26	56	**40.6**	±5.4	35.2–46.0
Organizational Artifacts	11	**9**	—	—	—	**Only 9 stories — too few to score**	—	—
Organizational History	55	52	50	36	64	**49.3**	±5.6	43.7–54.9
Organizational Stories	50	47	47	31	58	**44.7**	±5.9	38.8–50.6
Rituals and Rites of Passage	46	44	63	51	70	**60.9**	±5.8	55.1–66.7
Stakeholder Relations	64	61	69	57	73	**66.0**	±5.2	60.8–71.2

Arithmetic checks

- Values: 0.35×58 + 0.35×42 + 0.30×67 = 20.3 + 14.7 + 20.1 = 55.1
- HR Systems: 14.7 + 9.1 + 16.8 = 40.6
- History: 17.5 + 12.6 + 19.2 = 49.3
- Stories: 16.45 + 10.85 + 17.4 = 44.7
- Rituals: 22.05 + 17.85 + 21.0 = 60.9
- Stakeholders: 24.15 + 19.95 + 21.9 = 66.0

Artifacts: 11 stories were told, but only 9 placed any stones, so the thinnest input is 9 and the domain is not scored. Its stones percentages are not printed either (figures under 10 stories are suppressed).

Exhibit 9: Under the composites

9a. Dyads (% toward the healthier end; the composite uses the mean of the two)

Domain	"Knew what to expect"	"More connected"	Mean (Dyad + %)
Values	60	56	58
HR Systems	54	30	42
History	44	56	50
Stories	41	53	47
Rituals	58	68	63
Stakeholders	66	72	69

9b. Stone quadrants (% of placements; each row sums to 100)

Domain	Healthy	Complicated	Chaotic	Rigid
Values	42	18	17	23
HR Systems	26	12	22	40
History	36	15	29	20
Stories	31	17	34	18
Rituals	51	21	12	16
Stakeholders	57	19	11	13

9c. Triad ("In this story, what was really driving people?"; each row sums to 100)

Domain	Shared purpose	Getting the job done	Avoiding blame (concerning)	Non-concerning
Values	30	37	33	67
HR Systems	24	32	44	56
History	22	42	36	64
Stories	27	31	42	58
Rituals	38	32	30	70
Stakeholders	41	32	27	73

Exhibit 10: "Where to start" as the report prints it (wave 1)

The report compares each domain with the lowest (HR Systems, 40.6 ± 5.4) and the highest (Stakeholders, 66.0 ± 5.2). Two scores are "told apart" when their difference is larger than the two margins combined: $\sqrt{(m_1^2 + m_2^2)}$, rounded to one decimal.

Comparison	Difference	Bar (combined margin)	Told apart?
Stories vs HR Systems	4.1	$\sqrt{(5.4^2 + 5.9^2)} = 8.0$	No → **Start here**
History vs HR Systems	8.7	$\sqrt{(5.4^2 + 5.6^2)} = 7.8$	**Yes**, although the two published ranges overlap (43.7–46.0)
Values vs HR Systems	14.5	$\sqrt{(5.4^2 + 5.0^2)} = 7.4$	Yes
Rituals vs Stakeholders	5.1	$\sqrt{(5.8^2 + 5.2^2)} = 7.8$	No → **Protect**
Values vs Stakeholders	10.9	$\sqrt{(5.0^2 + 5.2^2)} = 7.2$	Yes

Printed groups

- **Start here:** Organizational Stories, HR Management Systems and Processes (named as a group, not in order)
- **Protect:** Stakeholder Relations, Rituals and Rites of Passage
- **Not yet heard:** Organizational Artifacts
- Espoused Beliefs and Values and Organizational History sit in no group.
- No "Going backwards" or "Improving": this is the first wave.

Exhibit 13: Culture Mosaic alongside (Feb 2026 survey, 412 respondents)

Shown on the current Culture Mosaic tile set: Customer in Adapt, Decisions in Deliver, the same twelve tiles as the Leadership Mosaic.

Dig domain	Paired Culture Mosaic tiles (score)	What the pairing tests (product wording, abridged)
Espoused Beliefs and Values	Values 66, Purpose 82, Strategy 51, Decisions 73	Whether values, purpose and strategy guide the work and decisions are sound, against what actually guided a decision
HR Systems	Capability Development 53, Empowered Teams 49	Whether people are developed and supported, against what the people systems did to them
Artifacts	Efficiency 57, Collaboration 44	Whether work gets done well and together, against what the tools and spaces make easy or hard
History	Change Ready 48, Future Focused 55	Readiness for change, against how people remember past changes
Stories	Values 66, Learning 61	Whether values shape behavior, against which behavior the passed-on stories reward
Rituals	Capability Development 53, Collaboration 44	Growth and teamwork, against how joining, progressing and leaving are marked
Stakeholders	Customer 74	Whether customers and partners matter, against what happened when one needed something

Rule: never compare these numbers with the dig composites. Compare what a survey statement asserts with what the stories describe: words against words.

Exhibit 15: The Clinic Network request (Part A)

From Taylor Brooks (VP, Clinic Operations), Mon Jun 14, 2027:

"The dig told us HR systems and the stories people pass on are where to start, but it couldn't tell me what's happening in my clinics specifically. I want a dig of our own for the six clinics. I'd like results for each clinic so I can see where the problems are, and I'd like to be the Program Lead so I can keep an eye on it. Can we start on August 16 and have a report for the board offsite on October 21? Reuse the clinic people who did the first one if you can."

The Clinic Network

Clinic	Origin	Staff
Lakeside Main	Former Lakeside	34
Oak Park	Former Lakeside	22
Harbor Street	Former Lakeside	26
Millbrook	Former Lakeside	**18**
Riverside	Legacy Northwind	28
Hillcrest	Legacy Northwind	22
Total		**150**

Facts to work with

- Taylor Brooks was CEO of Lakeside Clinic Group before the merger, and is not a member of Northwind's SurveyCraft organization.
- Jordan Reyes is still an Admin of the organization.
- Alex Moreau is the organization's only Owner; Jamie Ortiz (wave 1's second lead) is an Editor.
- Wave 1 researchers who work in the clinics: Avery Lin, Rowan Patel, Jules Carter, Drew Ortega, Frankie Diaz, Marlowe Fisher, Robin Tate (7). All except Rowan Patel joined Northwind's organization only through the dig (dig-only memberships).
- Wave 1's story collection asked no site or role question (nobody listed sites), so its stories can't be split by clinic.
- The org-wide program's wave 2 story window is planned for Nov 15 – Dec 6, 2027.
- "Suggest dates" from Mon Aug 16, 2027 gives: findings **Mon Sep 6 (Labor Day)**, stories close Mon Sep 20, analysis Mon Sep 27, report Mon Oct 11. August is peak vacation season.
- Wave 1 in the clinics: of the 356 org-wide stories, the number from clinic staff is unknown (no site list in wave 1).
- Prices: see the current Mosaic price sheet. None are needed for the task.

Exhibit 16: Evidence pack (Part B), part 1

The question to answer for Alex Moreau and the executive team: **"Why do decisions feel closed?"** Use Exhibits 8, 9, 10 and 13 plus the material below and on the next page.

16a. Team synthesis extracts

- **HR Systems** (submitted Apr 30; 14 observations, 3 artifacts): "Scheduling and float-pool decisions now sit with the central staffing office under the One Northwind rules. Managers describe the rules as clear and fair on paper. Frontline staff describe learning about schedule decisions after they are made, and managers say they spend time 'translating' decisions they had no part in. Former Lakeside clinic staff describe losing local say over schedules. Evidence on promotion is thin: we heard four accounts and could not corroborate a pattern."
- **Stories** (submitted May 5, overdue; 11 observations, 1 artifact): "The story newcomers hear most is about covering for each other when things go wrong. A second, quieter set of stories warns against raising problems in huddles: three interviewees, on different units, told versions of a story about someone labeled 'difficult' after questioning a staffing decision. We are confident about the first pattern and less sure how widely the second is told."
- **Values** (submitted Apr 29): "People name 'patients first' without prompting; few of the 18 people we interviewed could name the four official values. Decisions about One Northwind are explained at town halls, but people describe hearing about them after they are made, often from a colleague first."

16b. HR Systems observations (selected, already anonymized)

Who and how	What they said	Tagged
Night-shift RN, hospital, interview	"The schedule comes out of the staffing office. My manager finds out when I do."	*Schedules decided centrally*
Clinic manager, former Lakeside clinic, interview	"I spend Monday mornings explaining decisions I wasn't in the room for."	*Managers translating decisions*
Medical assistant, legacy Northwind clinic, interview	"Swaps used to be a conversation with my lead. Now it's a form and a wait."	*Schedules decided centrally*
Staffing coordinator, corporate, interview	"The rules are the same for everyone now. That was the point."	*One set of rules*

Exhibit 16: Evidence pack (Part B), part 2

16c. Story summaries (AI-drafted, approved by Alex, May 20)

H1 (HR Systems: "Think of a recent decision about your schedule, role or development…", 34 stories)

Kind of story	Stories	Tone (AI reading)
Schedules decided centrally, explained afterwards	14	10 negative, 4 mixed
A manager who found a way	9	7 positive, 2 mixed
Same rules, applied differently by site	7	4 negative, 3 mixed
A quick, clear answer through the process	4	4 positive

Tone vs placement (H1): 31 stories had stones placed. **8** were read as positive but placed on the draining side; none the other way. 8 of 31 = 26%, flagged as worth saying. (11 stories were read as positive in all; 8 of them were placed draining.)

S1 (Stories: "Tell us about something that happened here that you think could only have happened in this organization.", 27 stories)

Kind of story	Stories	Tone (AI reading)
Covering for each other when things go wrong	10	6 positive, 4 mixed
The person who spoke up and paid for it	8	7 negative, 1 mixed
Lakeside ways versus Northwind ways	6	4 mixed, 2 negative
Patients first, whatever it takes	3	3 positive

V1 (Values: "Tell us about a time you heard about an important decision…", 36 stories)

Kind of story	Stories	Tone (AI reading)
Heard after it was done	17	12 negative, 5 mixed
Told the why by my manager	11	9 positive, 2 mixed
Heard it from a colleague first	8	3 negative, 5 mixed

16d. What the analysis read. Analyze read 12 stories per domain, spread evenly across the collection window; the scores and summaries use every story (summaries up to 150 per prompt).